



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

June 10, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session and was called to order at 6:32 p.m. by Mayor Daniel J. Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy May Davis.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy Davis, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Chris Simpson, and Assistant City Engineer Jeff Crow.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to adopt the agenda. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS:

A. Renewable Energy Presentation by Consumers Energy

Ryan Buchinger of Consumers Energy presented Consumers Energy Renewable Energy Program.

PUBLIC HEARINGS: none.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Minutes of the May 27, 2025, Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council

B. City of Jackson, Michigan Financial Statements for the Ten Months Ended April 30, 2025

C. Special Event Application: Sparky's Fireworks Outlet Customer Appreciation Show

Approve a request from Sparky's Fireworks Outlet to host Sparky's Fireworks Outlet Customer Appreciation Show on June 21, 2025, at Jackson Speedway.

D. Special Event Application: Commercial Exchange Open-house

Approve a request from ComEx Holdings LLC to host the Commercial Exchange Open-house on June 27 and June 28, 2025, at the Commercial Exchange Building.

E. Appointment – Local Officers Compensation Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint David Hammontree to the Local Officers Compensation Commission for a seven-year term beginning immediately and ending on June 10, 2032.

F. Resolution to approve a Change to the Standard Lighting Contract with Consumers Energy

Approve a Resolution for a Change to the Standard Lighting Contract with Consumers Energy for the removal of a streetlight at the intersection of Lansing Avenue and Monroe Street and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.

G. Special Even Application: Uptown Salon Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting
Approve a request from the Uptown Hairstyling Salon LLC to host the Uptown Salon Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting on June 30, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the consent calendar. Councilmember Davis requested that Item E be removed for separate consideration. Vote was taken on the amended consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint David Hammontree to the Local Officers Compensation Commission for a seven-year term beginning immediately and ending on June 10, 2032. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. East Side Economic Development Update

City Manager Jonathan Greene provided Council an update.

B. Ordinance No. 519

Recommendation: *Approve the second reading/final adoption of Ordinance No. 519 approving the compensation rates for administrative and supervisory employees*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Davis to approve the second reading/final adoption of Ordinance No. 519 approving the compensation rates for administrative and supervisory employees. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Resolution - Water and Wastewater Rate

Recommendation: *Approval of Option #1 for the fiscal years 2025/26 and 2026/27 Water and Wastewater Rate Resolution.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve Option #1 for the fiscal years 2025/26 and 2026/27 Water and Wastewater Rate Resolution. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Wood, and Forgrave (4). Nays: Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, and Davis (3). Motion carried.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. Resolution - Fiscal Year 2024/25 Budget Amendment

Recommendation: *Approval of the Resolution to amend the fiscal year 2024/25 General Fund, Ella W. Sharp Park Operating Fund, Building Inspection Fund, 2023 Water System Project Construction Fund, 2024 Water System Project Construction Fund, and Water Fund budgets*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the resolution to amend the fiscal year 2024/25 General Fund, Ella W. Sharp Park Operating Fund, Building Inspection Fund, 2023 Water System Project Construction Fund, 2024 Water System Project Construction Fund, and Water Fund budgets. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Forgrave (6). Nays: Councilmember Davis (1). Motion carried.

B. Downtown Development Authority Budget, Fiscal Year 2025 –2026

Recommendation: *Approve the Jackson Downtown Development Authority budget for the fiscal year 2025-2026.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the Jackson Downtown Development Authority budget for the fiscal year 2025-2026. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Resolution - FY25/26 DDA District Millage

Recommendation: *Approve a resolution authorizing the levy of a millage in the amount of 1.9996 mills on parcels in the DDA District for the fiscal year 2025-26*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve a resolution authorizing the levy of a millage in the amount of 1.9996 mills on parcels in the DDA District for the fiscal year 2025-26. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. 2025-2026 Insurance Renewal

Recommendation: *Approve the Renewal of the City of Jackson's Liability and Property Insurance through the Michigan Municipal League's Liability & Property Pool in the Amount of \$709,078.00, and Authorize the City Attorney and Finance Director to Take Any Actions Necessary to Effectuate the Policy.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Robinson, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the renewal of the City of Jackson's Liability and Property Insurance through the Michigan Municipal League's Liability & Property Pool in the amount of \$709,078.00, and authorize the City Attorney and Finance Director to take any actions necessary to effectuate the policy. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. Contract Award - FY 2025/26 Water and Wastewater Treatment chemicals.

Recommendation: *Award Contracts for the Fiscal Year 2025/2026 purchase of Water and Wastewater Treatment chemicals.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to award contracts for the Fiscal Year 2025/2026 purchase of water and wastewater treatment chemicals. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CLOSED SESSION:

A. Conduct closed session pursuant to MCL 15.268(e) concerning Jackson County 4th Circuit Court Case No. 24-1054-NO

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to conduct a closed session pursuant to MCL 15.268(e) concerning Jackson County 4th Circuit Court Case No. 24-1054-NO. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to return from closed session. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the settlement in Meher v. City of Jackson, Jackson County 4th Circuit Court Case No. 24-1054-NO as recommended by the City Attorney and claims counsel. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER'S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Davis offered comments. Councilmember Forgrave declined to offer comments.

MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 8:57 p.m.